Alejandro de la Fuente

Curriculum Vitae

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Profile

PhD researcher at the Barcelona Supercomputing Center (BSC) and the University of Barcelona (UB), specialised in large language models (LLMs) as a research method for the social sciences. I use LLMs to measure political content at scale, validate their output against human coding, and build experiments in which participants interact with LLM-driven agents. I apply these methods to online information diets, political polarization and incivility, combining passive web-tracking data with surveys of the same panelists.

Academic appointments and research experience

2025–present **PhD Researcher**, *Barcelona Supercomputing Center (BSC) & University of Barcelona (UB)*, Barcelona, Spain
Research on political information diets and polarization using web-tracking data and surveys. Development of large-scale text classification pipelines with LLMs on HPC infrastructure (MareNostrum 5).

Feb 2024–Dec 2024 **Research Assistant**, *University of Zurich*, Remote, Switzerland
Swiss National Science Foundation (SNF) project on online incivility. Large-scale data collection, database construction, literature review and statistical analysis in R.

Sep 2023–Apr 2024 **Research Assistant**, *Princeton University*, Remote, USA
Large-scale dataset processing and content classification pipelines for empirical research projects.

2021–2022 **Collaboration Scholarship (Ministry of Education)**, *University of Valladolid*, Valladolid, Spain
Research on electricity market structure and market power in European energy markets.

Feb 2022–May 2022 **Internship**, *Economic and Social Council of Castilla y León (CES)*, Valladolid, Spain
Preparation of economic and social reports on regional economic conditions.

Publications and working papers

Preprint **Beyond the Link: Assessing LLMs' Ability to Classify Political Content across Global Media**. With A. Martinez-Serra, N. Visscher, L. Castro and A. S. Cardenal. `https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.17435`

Working paper **Who Reads What—and How Fast? Partisan Asymmetries in Political News Consumption**.

Working paper **Pathways to Polarization: Online Information-Seeking Among Political Extremists**. With L. Castro, Y. Zhang, F. Esser, K. Syed Ali and M. Amsler.

Working paper **Bridging the Self-Report Gap: Behavioural Measures of Partisan News Consumption**.

Working paper **Leveraging Large Language Models to Enhance Supervised Classification of Political Incivility on Social Media**.

Working paper **What Counts as AI Use? Comparing Self-Reports and Digital Traces in a Spanish Online Panel**. With A. Martinez-Serra, J. C. Niculica, A. Rodilla and A. S. Cardenal.

Working paper **The Collective Turing Test Revisited: Can Humanized Multi-Agent Systems Simulate Online Political Discussion?**.

Working paper **What the Platform Leaves Behind: Iron March's Shutdown and Hate Crime in U.S. Counties**.

Working paper **Broadband Availability and Turnout Change in Spain's 2016 Repeat Election**.

Working paper **From Browsing to Prompting: How AI Challenges Web Tracking Data**.

Conference presentations

2026 BSC Workshop on AI/ML Applied Methods in Computational Social Sciences and Humanities Research, Barcelona: *Who Reads What—and How Fast?*

2026 XVIII Congress of the Spanish Political Science Association (AECPA), Granada: *Who Reads What—and How Fast?* and *Leveraging Large Language Models to Enhance Supervised Classification of Political Incivility*.

2026 European Political Science Society (EPSS), Belfast: *Bridging the Self-Report Gap*.

2026 13th BSC Severo Ochoa Doctoral Symposium, Barcelona: *Pathways to Polarization*.

2025 International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), Norrköping: *Pathways to Polarization*.

2025 European Political Science Association (EPSA), Madrid: *Pathways to Polarization* and *When the Internet Sheds Light on Corruption*.

2025 International Communication Association (ICA), Denver: *Pathways to Polarization*.

2025 Doctoral seminar, Law and Political Science PhD programme, University of Barcelona: *Scrolling into Extremes: Tracing the Digital Echo Chamber's Road to the Polls*; discussant.

Research projects

Horizon Europe **WHAT-IF**: A Digital Twin of the Information Environment. Grant agreement No. 101177574. PhD researcher. `https://what-if-horizon.eu/`

AEI (Spain) **DEMOS-AI**: Decoding Moral and Sociopolitical Biases in AI. PID2025-172779NA-I00. Research team. `https://demos-ai.duckdns.org/`

"la Caixa" **CSSINFOYOUTH**: Political information diets of young people in Spain on TikTok, Instagram and YouTube. Social Research call 2024, PI Laia Castro (UB). Research team.

AEI (Spain) **ONLINEHATE**: El efecto de la incivilidad online en la participación electoral: evidencia de cinco redes sociales. PID2023-150282NA-I00. Research team.

SNF Project No. 204483 — From Uncivil Disagreement to Political Unrest? A Cross-Platform and Cross-National Analysis of the Offline Consequences of Online Incivility. Research assistant (2024).

Service

2026 Organizing committee, BSC Workshop on AI/ML Applied Methods in Computational Social Sciences and Humanities Research.

2026 Reviewer, *Research & Politics*.

2025 Organizing committee, 12th BSC Severo Ochoa Doctoral Symposium.

2024 Organizing team, Computational Social Science Conference: innovative methods, research workflows and data stewardship (CODATA, BSC and Fundació la Caixa).

Education

2025–present **PhD**, *Law and Political Science programme, University of Barcelona*, Barcelona, Spain
Doctoral research in computational social science and political communication.

2022–2024 **MSc, Institutions and Political Economy**, *University of Barcelona*, Barcelona, Spain
Average grade: 9.02/10. Honors in Research Design, Game Theory, and Data Science II.

2018–2022 **BSc, Economics**, *University of Valladolid*, Valladolid, Spain
Average grade: 8.39/10. Multiple honors across core economics courses and honors distinction in final thesis.

Training

2025 ICA Journals Peer Review Workshop for Student and Early-Career Scholars, Denver.

2024 Using Large Language Models for Empirical Research in Social Science (Gaël Le Mens), IBEI Graduate Summer School.

Methods and tools

Programming R; Python; LaTeX; Git.

Methods LLM-based classification and validation; LLM-driven experiments; text-as-data; causal inference with observational data; web-tracking and survey linkage.

Infrastructure HPC (MareNostrum 5); reproducible research workflows. Software: STAGELab, turing-test-platform.

Languages Spanish (native), English (B2).